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Graduate Recruitment Team

Kiltearn Partners LLP

22 Charlotte Square

Edinburgh EH2 4DF

Dear Sir or Madam,

I am writing to ask to be considered for a junior investment analyst role in Edinburgh. I am a final-year Economics student at the University of Strathclyde, graduating in summer 2027 with a predicted 2:1. Kiltearn's single global equity programme, run since 2011 with a disciplined value philosophy, is the kind of concentrated, research-led investing I would most like to learn, and it is run from Edinburgh.

My work keeps returning to one question: does an apparent edge survive a proper test? I tested CAPM on 694 anomaly portfolios across 54 countries and rejected zero alpha jointly in 48 of 53, with momentum the most persistent anomaly. My dissertation, supervised by Dr Luigi Gifuni, estimates petro-currencies' oil betas from OPEC announcement-day surprises, tests whether Norway's krone conversions, Russia's 2017–22 budget rule and Mexico's put hedge make them smaller, kinked or one-sided, and asks whether any beta that remains survives costs and a White reality check. As co-founder of the Strathclyde Agricapital Society, I also built a wheat calendar-spread strategy whose weekly backtest returned a Sharpe ratio of 0.76 before costs and 0.28 after, which taught me how quickly turnover erodes an edge.

Hedge funds appeal to me because the distance between an idea and its consequences is short: a research view becomes a position, and the position is marked every day. I take that accountability seriously. As Vice-President and then President of the Strathclyde Poker Society, I taught new members to use the Kelly criterion to work out how many buy-ins their win rate, variance and risk tolerance call for, with a buffer because their edge is only an estimate; a position sized on an uncertain alpha needs the same caution. As Treasurer of the Agricapital Society, which I helped grow to 126 members, I manage its budget and accounts.

Kiltearn stands out to me because it screens world equity markets on valuation and then does deep fundamental work on a focused set of holdings, an approach my own research supports: across 54 countries, value was among the most persistent anomalies once tested properly. I would be glad to be considered for any junior analyst opening and to bring my econometrics and my habit of writing research up clearly to a small Edinburgh team.

I would welcome the opportunity to discuss my application. Thank you for your time and consideration.

Yours faithfully,

Will McGowan